# Attitudes of Filipino Millennials Towards Purchase and Consumption of Luxury Brands: Actual and Ideal Self-Congruity on Brand Attitude

Prof. Marilou Q. Tolentino, DBA
Dean, College of Business
Systems Plus College Foundation, Angeles City, Philippines

## Abstract

The study aimed to determine the motivation behind the attitude of Filipino millennials in their purchase and consumption of luxury brands. Various studies in other countries, demographic profiles, and different cultural contexts had provided rich knowledge and vantage point on the perspectives of buyers on luxury brands towards purchase and use. The attitude of Filipino millennials regarding their actual and ideal self-congruity towards the luxury brand is the leading primary focus of the study, i.e., determining the factors that influence or motivate Filipino millennials in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands. Furthermore, additional considerations of materialistic value and status values were examined regarding how and to what extent they affect consumer motivation. The research questions and the hypothesis of the study were dealt with and resolved through quantitative research. The study had utilized a survey method using a structured survey questionnaire administered to university students, young graduates, and young professionals classified as millennials in various organizations. The study found out that significantly, the motivation indicating that Filipino millennial consumers' towards ideal self-congruency are higher than the effect of actual self-congruity towards their attitudes on luxury brands. The influence is well defined from among the respondents in terms of their attitude towards materialistic value and prestige value. The implication of the study will provide a body of knowledge to both business and academic perspectives. The research results will be a scientific basis towards understanding the brand attitude of Filipino millennials which make up one-third of the country's total population; considerably half of the labor force population. The effect of variables used in the study was not studied in depth in the Philippine context. Moreover, the results of the study will contribute to luxury brand managers who need guidance in choosing the right marketing mix and marketing strategies when targeting millennial consumers.

Keywords: consumer attitude, luxury brand, Filipino millennials, actual & ideal self-congruity, purchase, and consumption, motivational factors,

*** *Paper presented at the "International Conference on Marketing, Tourism and Hospitality ICT19Las Vegas Conference, Las Vegas-USA. May 24-26, 2019*

## Introduction

The luxury industry, as tracked by Bain, encompasses both luxury goods and experiences. It comprises nine segments, led by luxury cars, luxury hospitality and personal luxury goods, which together account for more than 80% of the total market. Overall, the luxury market grew 5% in 2018, to an estimated €1.2 trillion globally, with positive performance across

most segments. Sales of luxury cars continued to dominate the market, growing 5% at constant exchange rates to €495 billion. Luxury experiences remained very attractive to consumers, as illustrated by sales growth of luxury hospitality (up 5% from last year), gourmet food and fine dining (up 6%) and luxury cruises (up 7%). Moreover, online purchases reached an 8% market share, and overall discounted sales reached 37% of the total market. (D'Arpizio et al., 2016). Luxury brand purchases from among younger generations, generation-y or the millennials, i.e., people born in the 1980s and 1990s value luxury products at a younger age than the traditional luxury customers had increased considerably. ( The Economist, 2014),)

They are also very different in their buying behavior, being more spontaneous, experimenting, and exploring new brands. Thus, they are a contrast of the traditional luxury consumers that have more consistent spending behavior and brand loyalty. (Jay, 2012) It is estimated that by 2026 the primary consumers of luxury will be the millennials and, therefore, managers need to adapt their marketing and brand management strategies accordingly to capture this vast and rapidly growing customer segment to outperform the competition (The Economist, 2014).

The brand is a central part of consumer decision making. However, currently, there is a limited amount of research regarding the determinants of luxury consumption and luxury brand management. Particularly the connection between consumer perception of luxury and what causes customers to purchase luxury brands is rightly understood and widely unexplored. (Hennigs et al., 2013). This is a classic case of the Philippines. Luxury brands can satisfy consumers' psychological and functional needs, having a combination of four dimensions of value: financial, operational, individual, and social value (Wiedmann et al., 2007). From these four different luxury values, the customers can be segmented by focusing on personally oriented vs. socially-oriented customers. In other words, whether luxury brands are purchased for their pleasure or demonstration of success. (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009) Therefore, luxury brands need to deliver value by customers' subjective expectations and individual perceptions (Hennigs et al., 2013).

Millennials are now the subject of many studies, which is a puzzling phenomenon to generations of humans. The generation is socially connected and obsessed with social media and IT applications and infrastructure.

One-third of the Filipinos are millennials age ranges from 15 to 35 years old. The Millenials share the same values and identities that are of different layers. Accordingly, there are different versions of Millenials depending on what they want to show the world. Within this perspective, brands should engage more the Millenials and converting them into their marketability and affiliation. Posit to this, and the millennial adhere to integrity based on shared experience rather than in the power of authority. http://pana.com.ph/decoding-

millennials/

## Literature Review

The term luxury is widely used, and an absolute definition for it does not exist. What is luxury for some is not for others. (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014) However, there are specific attributes that are used to define luxury, which is: excellent quality, high price, scarcity and uniqueness, aesthetics and polysensuality, ancestral heritage and personal history, and superfluousness (Dubois et al., 2001).

Luxury is not the equivalent to fashion or premium, even though these concepts are linked to each other and borrow associations from each other (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014: 35). However, by only having a particular attribute of the previously mentioned (Table 1), such as high price, is not sufficient by itself to define luxury. Therefore, the upper- range branded premium products are often confused with luxury. Whereas for premium products price is based on functionality, performance, and quality, for leisure, it is related to scarcity, brand, and storytelling (Turunen, 2015). On the other hand, many luxury brands adopt the behavior of fashion brands, whereas fashion seeks to belong to the world of luxury to improve their status (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

Furthermore, luxury products are related to being a dream, whereas essential products correspond to a need, and in between are the branded products corresponding to a desire that lasts for a while, and they are substitutable. Dreams are beyond requirements or want and are what luxury products respond to and separates luxury products from non-luxury products. (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014) Purchasing a luxury product is buying into a dream, and these purchases are often impulsive, emotional or extravagant (Dubois & Paternault, 1995). Consequently, luxury is an industry with a high level of profitability with high margins in luxury product prices, and top brand equity and brands' fame generate additional value for expensive, original quality products (Kapferer, 1997).

Luxury brands can be categorized by the degree of luxury, i.e., the accessibility level, divided into available, intermediate, and inaccessible luxury brands (De Barnier et al., 2011). Other proposed luxury degree categorizations that are based on previous literature (Vigneron & Johnson, 1999; Kapferer, 2008; Corbellini & Saviolo, 2009) are summarized in Figure 2 (Turunen, 2015: 122). Mainly various brand extensions of luxury brands expanding to new categories have caused additional unclarity of how to define luxury. When luxury brands introduce lower-end extensions, consumers get a taste of the luxury brand at this available product level of, for example, perfumes. (Patrick & Prokopec, 2015). To understand consumer motivations for purchasing luxury, it is crucial to understand the underlying value that the product has for the consumer when in use (Ballantyne & Varey, 2006). People consume products in different ways, and the interpersonal and personal actions vary for

different luxury consumers (Holt, 1995). Consumers seek to create a meaningful life regarding personal identity and social relationships so that products consumed contribute to the consumer's particular quality of life through the enjoyment coming from owning and consuming products and experiences (Pollay, 1983; Solomon et al., 2016). The consumer perception of luxury brands affects thus the relevance of consumption. To understand how consumers individualize their opinions of luxury and how luxury brands change their daily lives, consumers' consumption values should be investigated. (Seo & Buchanan-Oliver, 2014)

Luxury consumers can be divided into heavy users and occasional users, according to Kapferer and Bastien (2014). Until about the year 2000 luxury market was mostly growing because of a large number of middle-class consumers purchasing luxury occasionally. Nowadays, the first volume of luxury purchases comes from customers that consume frequently. The Western middle classes are increasingly worried about their future, thus, feeling poorer and moving towards the less affluent categories, whereas the wealthy purchasers have maintained their optimism, making up for the majority of the luxury market. This polarization of the market has allowed luxury brands to grow sales of their entry-level masstige products to the middle-class consumers who have kept their aspirations but are now more deliberate about their spending. On the other hand, young Chinese middle-class customers are the opposite of the Popular Western ones as, even though they have significantly less money, their income is perceptibly increasing, so they feel more optimistic and prosperous, making the luxury market in China very dynamic. A similar pattern could be explaining the growing numbers of generation- y consumers purchasing luxury, particularly after the recession of 2008 as they increasingly look for self-indulgence through luxury consumption (Jay, 2012).

In a research done by Kapferer (1998) with an international sample of affluent young consumers, four types of luxury clients were identified in terms of what luxury means to them and what characteristics they value in luxury products. Firstly, it is the group that appreciates the beauty, excellence, and uniqueness of the luxury product. Secondly, for the next segment, the focus is on luxury products' creativity and sensuality. Thirdly, the luxury value is based on timelessness and international reputation, thus being a safe choice. And finally, the fourth type of benefit is focusing on rarity and the most inaccessible products, these being the buyers of the most expensive items. It was also found that the fourth group consisted mostly of males, whereas the second segment mainly consisted of females. This could give some idea of differences between luxury consumption value distinction between males and females, indicating that males consume more the blatant signs of success, whereas females value more creativity, sensuality, and beauty. In this aspect, young males instead consume the sign to show their progress. Also, the third group of consumers is motivated by active and visible signs and well-recognized brand names. In contrast, the second group is more

concerned about showing their individuality, and the first group sees themselves as connoisseurs, aesthetes and capable of appreciating exceptional products.

Another type of segmentation of luxury consumers is done by Han et al. (2010). This study takes the aspect of consumers' motivational factors further, distinguishing customers based on the role of brand prominence for signaling status, meaning the conspicuousness of the logo on a product. The more a consumer needs status, the more they use these so-called loud signals of showing the brand logo on products they consume. The opposite is for people with a low need for status. Consumers with high wealth and lesser need of status instead signal between each other with quiet, not so distinct brand signals, the logo not being conspicuously displayed. Their premium-priced luxury products are recognized by other people belonging to he same customer segment. On the other hand, wealthy customers in need of status consume loud luxury products to signal the less affluent that they are not one of them. And the less affluent with a high demand for status is consuming full, mostly counterfeit luxury products since they cannot afford the real ones, to mimic the more affluent and want to be perceived higher class. This segmentation is illustrated in Figure 4 (Han et al., 2010: 17). Therefore, consumers can be influenced by their group, those that they aspire to be like, and those with whom they do not want to be associated with. (Han et al., 2010).

According to Veblen (1965), accumulation of wealth does not always give a person status, but rather the evidence of wealth confers status. This can explain the conspicuous consumption of luxury as the symbol of one's success. People often define others through objects that are consumed by them. People also regard their possessions as parts of themselves. Furthermore, individuals might use personal belongings, particularly luxury products, to help define themselves and reflect their own identity. An individual might consume his or her products to express a distinct sense of being or can also express belonging to a particular group. With material possessions, people seek happiness and remind themselves of experiences, accomplishments and other people. Products that people possess convey a sense of past show who they are, where they come from, and where they are going. (Belk, 1988).

Not all brands are equally luxurious, and, as discussed earlier, luxury does not have one clear definition. Also, the degree of luxury for the same brand can be considered and perceived on a different level in different product categories and different situations. For example, Cartier may have a higher perceived luxury in the jewelry category and lower perceived luxury in the apparel or fragrance category. In the same way, Rolls-Royce is considered a luxury brand in the car category, but not a luxury brand in airplane engines type. (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004; Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

To facilitate distinguishing luxury brands, Vigneron and Johnson (2004) have developed a valuation model for measuring the amount of luxury comprised in a given brand. This Brand Luxury Index (BLI) shall consist of five perceived dimensions of a luxury brand (see Figure

5) (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004: 488). This framework includes three non-personal perceptions which are perceived conspicuousness, perceived uniqueness, and perceived quality. Furthermore, there are two personal-oriented perceptions of perceived hedonism and perceived the extended self. According to Vigneron and Johnson (2004), these five are the critical luxury dimensions that should be established and monitored for having a lasting luxury brand. A brand needs to manage both the personal and interpersonal perceptions for the long-lasting financial success of a luxury brand (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

Moreover, these five main perceptional factors are interrelated and are underlying in the decision-making process of a consumer when assessing luxury brands. Consumers value all these five dimensions. However, some aspects have different significance for different customers. The BLI scale can also be used for comparing different luxury brands and, thus, for recognizing competitive advantages identified in the target market. (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004)

According to Berthon et al. (2009), consumers' perceptions of luxury brands have three value dimensions: functional, experiential, and symbolic. Vickers and Renald (2003) also argue that there is a fundamental difference between these three dimensions for luxury brands and non-luxury brands as consumers expect more from luxury brands. Since these three value dimensions of luxury are contextual, they can change over time depending on the individual and socio-cultural beliefs, thus being co-created between a luxury brand and the consumers (Tynan et al., 2010).

The functional value dimension refers to the material representation of an object and the core benefit and essential utilities, such as quality, functionality, reliability, durability, or craftsmanship. In this value dimension, especially quality is vital since it signals how well the product can perform and what it does.

The experiential value dimension represents the individual subjective value, referring to an individual's taste and where one finds hedonic value in a brand. This can be evoked by brand experience related stimuli that are part of the brand's identity, such as design, packaging, communication, and environments, affecting consumer's sensations, feelings, cognitions, perceptions, and behavioral responses. (Berthon et al., 2009) Hence, luxury products provide need- or want-satisfying consumption experiences (Holbrook, 1999). Luxury being perceived as rare, precious and unique can guide individual thoughts and feelings towards a luxury brand because of uniqueness-seeking motivations as well, besides the hedonic motives (Hung et al., 2011). Experiential value, thus, answers what does the brand means to the individual.

The symbolic value dimension looks into what the brand means to others and the symbolic nature of the brand in the social collective (Berthon et al., 2009). The nominal value indicates conspicuousness, expensiveness and wealth (Hung et al., 2011). It is highly essential for premium-priced products and services as the symbolic nature signifies the developed dream

and brand story. There is an aspect of what luxury brand signals to others about the person consuming the brand, i.e., other-directed signaling, such as showing wealth, prestige, performance, or style. (Berthon et al., 2009) The symbolic dimension also has the self-directed value aspect by what the signaling has to the signaler, extending one's self and one's conspicuousness (Belk, 1988). However, a brand's symbolic value works only in a community, it is recognized at, and when being outside of this community, the social purpose is diminished.

The symbolic value is a particularly important consideration for global luxury brands' management and marketing as social influence affects the purchase intention, particularly for socially oriented consumers. (Tsai, 2005). Luxury brands need to manage well all these three dimensions and not overly focus on one size, neglecting the other two. For example, the quality of a luxury brand should not suffer because of the high focus on the symbolic aspect. Luxury brands should be a combination of material (objective, functional), individual (subjective, experiential), and social (collective, symbolic) spheres. (Berthon et al. 2009)

Wiedmann et al. (2007) have developed a conceptual framework. It shows that financial, functional, individual, and social dimensions affect the consumers' luxury value perception and consumption. These four key luxury value dimensions are strongly correlated but not identical with each other, and influence consumers' overall luxury value perception. The sub-dimensions of these four critical dimensions of luxury value perception are price value (financial value), usability value, quality value and uniqueness value (functional values), self-identity value, hedonic value and materialistic value (individual values), conspicuousness value and prestige value (social values). Even if the overall luxury level of a brand may be perceived equally, the critical luxury dimensions are seen differently by different consumer segments. The luxury value model by Wiedmann et al. (2007) facilitates to understand the conditions and drivers of luxury perception and, thus, consumer behavior as well. It, therefore, also helps to create, market and monitor luxury brands.

In general, Wiedmann et al. (2007) model seems to be the most complex and comprehensive. However, taking into account various previous research regarding the topic, there could also be other values that could be taken into consideration. For example, Ciornea et al. (2011) have added investment value to the financial value dimension and heritage value to the functional value dimension of the model. Many sub-dimensions could be added to the proposed benefits, such as superfluousness, which relates closely to the amount of materialism (Ciornea et al., 2011). Furthermore, the individual value and the social value dimensions and how consumers' overall perceived luxury value and the purchase intention of a luxury brand and what sizes are necessary to take into account. These characteristics will be looked into in more detail in the following sections and the research.

Millennials in the Philippines are addicted to gadgets, which financially drain their pockets,

to a certain extent, used ICT to save and get discounts on airfare tickets, food packages, travel deals, and other offers.

Visa had researched that 8o% of the Filipino Millennials prefer cash transactions than using credit cards. Meanwhile, the results found that Filipino Millennials do not trust the credit card system due to secrecy and confidentiality issues. Hence, financial on credit cards need to be advocated. https://www.ecomparemo.com/info/who-are-the-filipino-millennials-and-what-are-their-spending-habits/

According to Madelaine B. Miraflor, the purchasing power of millennials rapidly increases, which manifests in buying personal care products, home care, and food items on retail stores. The notion was supported by Kantar Worldpanel, which states that the capacity of Filipino millennials in purchasing personal and home cleanliness, convenience, and fun is growing. https://business.mb.com.ph/2016/11/19/millennials-purchasing-power-growing-study/

Background of the Study

The limited study on the attitude of Filipino Millennials in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands had been the primary interest of the study to establish scientific results for further studies that will provide a body of knowledge to both business and academic purposes.

The effect of variables used in the study based on the Philippine context is minimal; the subject area was not yet thoroughly researched during the conduct of the study.

Significance of the Study

The research results will be a scientific basis towards understanding the brand attitude of Filipino millennials, which make up one-third of the country's total population; considerably half of the labor force population.

Objectives of the Study

The purpose of this study is to study the impact that actual and ideal self-congruity has on millennial consumers' brand attitudes towards luxury brands. Furthermore, the effect of worldly value and status value dimensions is studied in terms of to what extent they affect millennials' brand attitudes regarding luxury brands.

It aims to contribute to the knowledge of understanding young consumers' brand attitudes and further buying behavior regarding luxury brands to maximize the commercial potential of this particular target group and to address the precise needs to grow the sales of this target group of generation-y consumers from among the Filipino millennials. The study purposively to determine:

1. Determine the motivation from among the Filipino Millennials in their purchase and

consumption of luxury brands in terms of actual self-congruity and ideal self-congruity.

2. Know the variables across the educational group, income groups, gender groups and age groups significantly affect the purchase and consumption of luxury brands from Filipino Millennials.

3. Determine the effect of materialistic value, status value, and social desirability scale results on the purchase and use of luxury brands from Filipino Millennials.

Statement of the Problem

This study focuses on the effects of actual and ideal self-congruity and how a consumer's self-image and luxury brand-image congruity affects brand attitude regarding luxury brands. The ideal self-image is the way an individual wants to be or would like to see him or herself and the meaning of self that the individual wishes others to associate with him or her, including attitudes, perceptions and feeling (Ross, 1971; Schenk & Holman, 1980).

Luxury brand consumption has a positive effect on approaching the ideal self-congruity by conveying the image and symbolic meaning of luxury brands to enhance an individual's perfect self-image.

Self-concept is of value to an individual, an individual's behavior is directed toward the enhancement of own self-concept through consumption of luxury goods and brands as symbols to communicate the symbolic meaning to the individual him or herself and others (Grubb & Grathwohl, 1967).

Brand attitude is an essential component for valuing a brand's equity. Brand attitude is an individual's overall evaluation of a brand, and it depends mainly on a consumer's perceptions of the brand. (Aaker, 1997) Additionally, self-congruity can be used to explain and predict brand attitude and purchase intention (Sirgy et al., 1997; Helgeson & Supphellen, 2004) Self-identity value, materialistic value, and status value are strictly related to each other (Richins & Dawson, 1992; Dittmar, 1994; Webster & Beatty, 1997.

1. *What extent are the Filipino Millennials motivated in their purchase and consumption of luxury brands in terms of actual self-congruity and ideal self-congruity?*
2. *What is the effect of materialistic value and status value on the purchase and consumption of luxury brands from Filipino Millennials?*
3. *Which variables across the educational group, income groups, gender groups and age groups significantly affect the purchase and consumption of luxury brands from among Filipino Millennials.*
4. *Which item shows significant correlations on the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino Millennials.*

## Methodology

The purpose of this study is to investigate the influence of actual and ideal self-congruity when formatting attitudes towards luxury brands. The study uses the descriptive research design which aims to study the relationship between the variables in the Philippine context. The survey was used for this study. Data was obtained by using a questionnaire and then standardizing the data for easy comparison. The study used primary and secondary data. The primary data was collected to answer the research question and to meet the research objectives. The questionnaire contains closed questions with pre-set answers to choose from, not providing open items. Thus, it is a highly structured questionnaire as the answers in respondents' own words are held to the minimum.

To specify luxury and non-luxury, some well-known brands in the Philippines were presented for both categories for respondents to choose from at the beginning of the questionnaire so that they can visualize a brand for the following questions. The study utilized a Likert Scale ranging from 1 to 5, i.e., from strongly disagree to agree on the response scale strongly. The study also used a shortened version of the Crowne-Marlowe social desirability scale (Crowne & Marlowe, 1960) to assess to what extent respondents are concerned with social approval, as social desirability bias is considered to be one of the most common biases affecting the results of survey research (King & Bruner, 2000). Low scoring on this scale can indicate that the respondent is less concerned about social approval and is more willing to answer survey questions truthfully and represent him or herself accurately (Crowne & Marlowe, 1960).

The respondents of the study were Filipino millennials from a higher education institution, young entrepreneurs, employees, employers and graduates who consume luxury brands were chosen to collect the data from as the research is interested in this particular population. The sample size was 134 respondents for this study which is sufficient enough to fulfill the requirements of efficiency, representativeness, reliability, and flexibility, which are the requirements of an optimal sample, according to Kothari (2004).

The study used the non-probability, convenience sampling selection is based on the easiness of getting responses. This research employs self-selection sampling in combination with convenience sampling. The questionnaire was distributed through the help of OJT students and alumni as enumerators.

## Data Analysis

The analysis of the data collected from the survey questionnaire has been done using SPSS, where the collected information was analyzed with the use of statistical tools. Particularly descriptive statistics have been used to describe and to compare variables numerically.

## Results

First, descriptive statistics were analyzed to generate background participants. The hypotheses were tested to validate the relationship of actual and ideal self-congruity concerning the materialistic value and status value which would reflect the brand attitudes towards luxury brands, looking into non-luxury brands. The study gathered data from 134 respondents.

This section looks into the demographic characteristics of the survey sample as well as into the Marlowe-Crowne social desirability scale results of the survey.

## Frequency Table

**Age**

| | | Frequency | Percent | Valid Percent | Cumulative Percent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Valid | 18-25 | 38 | 28.4 | 28.4 | 28.4 |
| | 26-30 | 51 | 38.1 | 38.1 | 66.4 |
| | 35 up | 45 | 33.6 | 33.6 | 100.0 |
| | Total | 134 | 100.0 | 100.0 | |

**Gender**

| | | Frequency | Percent | Valid Percent | Cumulative Percent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Valid | Male | 64 | 47.8 | 47.8 | 47.8 |
| | Female | 70 | 52.2 | 52.2 | 100.0 |
| | Total | 134 | 100.0 | 100.0 | |

**Education**

| | | Frequency | Percent | Valid Percent | Cumulative Percent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Valid | Secondary | 19 | 14.2 | 14.2 | 14.2 |
| | Bachelor | 69 | 51.5 | 51.5 | 65.7 |
| | Master | 10 | 7.5 | 7.5 | 73.1 |
| | PhD | 5 | 3.7 | 3.7 | 76.9 |
| | Other | 31 | 23.1 | 23.1 | 100.0 |
| | Total | 134 | 100.0 | 100.0 | |

**Income**

| | | Frequency | Percent | Valid Percent | Cumulative Percent |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Valid | below 15,000 | 30 | 22.4 | 22.4 | 22.4 |
| | 15,001 - 30,000 | 30 | 22.4 | 22.4 | 44.8 |
| | 30,001-50,000 | 37 | 27.6 | 27.6 | 72.4 |
| | 50,001 -75,000 | 21 | 15.7 | 15.7 | 88.1 |
| | 75,001 - 100,000 | 16 | 11.9 | 11.9 | 100.0 |
| | Total | 134 | 100.0 | 100.0 | |

The sample consisted of 47.8% (64) male respondents and 52.2% (70) female respondents.

Regarding the education level of the example, in terms of currently studying or the highest degree completed, the sample consisted of 51.5% (69) Bachelor, 7.5% (10) Master, and 3.7% (5) Ph.D., 14.2% (19) Secondary, and 23.1% (31) other respondents. The age range of the sample was from 18 to 37, with a median of 25 and a mean of 27.5. Thus, the distribution of gender is quite good, whereas the sample consists of a high number of respondents obtaining or obtained a master's degree. Also, the age range is good, representing millennial consumers of different ages. For the sample, the income level was not unusually high as most respondents were currently full-time students. As a result, it does not take the results of this question into account for the analysis.

The Marlowe-Crowne social desirability scale results are illustrated in the table below. More answers were totaled in the socially desirable responses, hence, implying that the survey results should be relatively reliable and respondents are, in particular, looking for social desirability in their answers to the questionnaire.

| Question: | T | F | |
|---|---|---|---|
| a) I have never intensely disliked anyone. | 88 | 46 | Sum of total answers: |
| b) Sometimes feel resentful when I don't get my way. | 50 | 84 | |
| c) Always careful about my manner of dress. | 114 | 20 | Socially Undesirable: 240 / 25.58% |
| d) If I could get into a movie without paying and be sure I was not seen, I would probably do it. | 17 | 117 | |
| e) I don't find it particularly challenging to get along with loudmouthed, obnoxious people. | 66 | 68 | |
| f) I sometimes think when people have a misfortune, they only got what they deserved. | 32 | 102 | Socially Desirable: 698 / 74.42% |
| g) I am sometimes irritated by people who ask favors of me. | 7 | 127 | |

Table: Marlowe-Crowne Social Desirability Scale Results

**Descriptive Statistics**

| | Minimum | Maximum | Mean | Std. Deviation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ASCL | 7 | 15 | 11.78 | 2.179 |
| ASCLN | 5 | 15 | 12.07 | 2.511 |
| ISCL | 7 | 15 | 11.97 | 2.278 |
| ISCLN | 5 | 15 | 11.73 | 2.636 |

ASCL – Actual Self Congruity on Luxury Brand

ASCLN – Actual Self Congruity on Non-Luxury Brand

ISCL – Ideal Self Congruity on Luxury Brand

ISCLN – Ideal Self Congruity on Non-Luxury Brand

ISCL (mean= 11.97) is higher than ASCL (mean = 11.78) : The respondents' attitude towards purchase and consumption of luxury brand is motivated more by their ideal self congruity than the actual self congruity

ASCLN (Mean = 12.07) is higher than ISCLN (Mean = 11.73): The respondents are motivated to purchase and consume non-luxury brand by their actual self congruity than on ideal self congruity

| Mean values for the variables across different age groups | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AGE | ASCL | MTV | ASCLN | ISCL | ISCLN | SV | SDR |
| 1 | 12.21 | 29.11 | 12.37 | 12.34 | 12.11 | 22.18 | 11.53 |
| 2 | 11.51 | 27.61 | 11.86 | 11.75 | 11.41 | 21.80 | 11.06 |
| 3 | 11.71 | 27.87 | 12.04 | 11.91 | 11.78 | 21.58 | 11.11 |
| Total | 11.78 | 28.12 | 12.07 | 11.97 | 11.73 | 21.84 | 11.21 |

All across variables, the age bracket of 18-25 y/o registered the highest mean values. This means that they are more motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brand and non-luxury brand both based on actual and ideal self congruity. They also have a higher regards to materialistic values, social values, and social desirability compared to other age bracket.

| Mean values for the variables across different gender groups | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| GENDER | ASCL | MTV | ASCLN | ISCL | ISCLN | SV | SDR |
| 1 | 11.98 | 30.53 | 12.36 | 12.20 | 11.92 | 24.09 | 12.08 |
| 2 | 11.59 | 25.91 | 11.80 | 11.76 | 11.56 | 19.77 | 10.41 |
| Total | 11.78 | 28.12 | 12.07 | 11.97 | 11.73 | 21.84 | 11.21 |

The male respondents dominated the female in all variables. The male are more motivated in the purchase of luxury brand based on actual and ideal self congruity compared to female. They put more value on materialistic (functionality), social (prestige, image, reputation), and social desirability values than female; interestingly, both gender groups are in agreement in all variables.

| Mean values for the variables across different education groups | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| EDUC | ASCL | MTV | ASCLN | ISCL | ISCLN | SV | SDR |
| 1 | 11.84 | 26.11 | 11.79 | 11.95 | 11.47 | 18.53 | 10.16 |
| 2 | 11.70 | 28.64 | 12.07 | 11.97 | 11.62 | 22.74 | 11.43 |
| 3 | 12.40 | 26.60 | 12.50 | 12.20 | 12.10 | 22.30 | 11.10 |
| 4 | 11.40 | 32.40 | 12.20 | 11.80 | 11.80 | 26.80 | 12.80 |
| 5 | 11.77 | 28.00 | 12.06 | 11.94 | 12.00 | 20.90 | 11.13 |
| Total | 11.78 | 28.12 | 12.07 | 11.97 | 11.73 | 21.84 | 11.21 |

The respondents with master's degree shows the highest mean in ASCL, ASCLN, ISCL. ISCLN, while respondents with doctorate has the highest mean in Materialistic value, social value, and social desirability scale.

The respondents with master's degree are motivated to purchase and consume more on luxury brand based on actual and ideal self congruity.

The doctorate degree holders are more motivated based on materialistic value, social value and social desirability scale.

| Mean values for the variables across different income groups | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| INCOME | ASCL | MTV | ASCLN | ISCL | ISCLN | SV | SDR |
| 1 | 11.73 | 25.20 | 12.20 | 12.23 | 11.90 | 18.30 | 10.00 |
| 2 | 12.07 | 28.77 | 12.33 | 12.20 | 12.07 | 22.67 | 11.47 |
| 3 | 12.05 | 30.73 | 12.51 | 12.30 | 12.11 | 24.03 | 12.08 |
| 4 | 11.14 | 29.19 | 11.05 | 11.24 | 10.90 | 23.05 | 11.71 |
| 5 | 11.50 | 24.94 | 11.63 | 11.25 | 11.00 | 20.25 | 10.31 |
| Total | 11.78 | 28.12 | 12.07 | 11.97 | 11.73 | 21.84 | 11.21 |

The respondents whose income bracket of 15,000-30,000 and 30,001 -50,000 expresses high motivation on the purchase and consumption of both luxury and non-luxury brand based on actual and ideal self congruity compared to other income bracket.

The response on materialistic value, social value and social desirability scale index as a motivation to purchase and consume had put income bracket of 30,001 – 50,000 and 50,001 – 75,000 to be the higher mean value.

Middle income earners from among Filipino millennials are more motivated to purchase and consume luxury brand and put more focus on the functionality, image or prestige and the social desirability or acceptance on the purchase and consumption of the product.

| ANOVA Age | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Mean Square | F | Sig. |
| ASCL | 5.489 | 1.159 | .317 |
| MTV | 26.577 | .726 | .486 |
| ASCLN | 2.802 | .441 | .645 |
| ISCL | 3.999 | .768 | .466 |
| ISCLN | 5.309 | .761 | .469 |
| SV | 3.830 | .121 | .886 |
| SDR | 2.704 | .616 | .542 |

No significant value based on age

| ANOVA Gender | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Mean Square | F | Sig. |
| ASCL | 5.313 | 1.120 | .292 |
| MTV | 712.666 | 22.759 | .000 |
| ASCLN | 10.461 | 1.668 | .199 |
| ISCL | 6.650 | 1.285 | .259 |
| ISCLN | 4.448 | .638 | .426 |
| SV | 624.608 | 23.345 | .000 |
| SDR | 92.554 | 25.056 | .000 |

Gender has a significant value on the materialistic value, social value and social desirability as a motivation to purchase and consume. As shown on the mean value, the male are more motivated to purchase and consume based on materialistic value, social value, and social desirability.

| ANOVA Education | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Mean Square | F | Sig. |
| ASCL | 1.282 | .264 | .900 |
| MTV | 52.690 | 1.466 | .216 |
| ASCLN | .857 | .132 | .970 |
| ISCL | .180 | .034 | .998 |
| ISCLN | 1.422 | .200 | .938 |
| SV | 104.184 | 3.594 | .008 |
| SDR | 9.371 | 2.228 | .070 |

As shown on the table, education as a variable has no significant value to all variables with almost significant value to social value and social desirability. As respondents attain a higher education the social value and social desirability would play a role in the purchase and consumption of product.

| ANOVA Income | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Mean Square | F | Sig. |
| ASCL * | 3.772 | .790 | .534 |
| MTV * | 176.612 | 5.504 | .000 |
| ASCLN * | 8.746 | 1.404 | .236 |
| ISCL * | 6.794 | 1.322 | .265 |
| ISCLN * | 8.096 | 1.171 | .327 |
| SV * | 161.124 | 5.918 | .000 |
| SDR * | 23.051 | 6.094 | .000 |

Income has a significant value to materialistic value, social value, and social desirability. As income increases the respondents are motivated to purchase and consume based on functionality, prestige, and social acceptance.

| Correlations | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| S. N. | Variables | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
| 1 | ASCL | | | | | | |
| 2 | MTV | 0.16 | | | | | |
| 3 | ASCLN | .891** | 0.12 | | | | |
| 4 | ISCL | .876** | 0.15 | .927** | | | |
| 5 | ISCLN | .872** | 0.12 | .942** | .899** | | |
| 6 | SV | 0.14 | .893** | 0.11 | 0.14 | 0.10 | |
| 7 | SDR | 0.09 | .954** | 0.06 | 0.08 | 0.06 | .948** |
| **. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed). | | | | | | | |

ASCL is correlated to ASCLN, ISCL, and ISCLN. The motivation to purchase and consume luxury brand based actual self congruity is related to ideal self congruity attitude on both luxury and non luxury brand as well as to actual self congruity on non luxury brand. The Filipino millennials purchase and consumption are all related regardless of luxury and non luxury or actual and ideal self congruity. Significantly, as the Materialistic Value is correlated to Social Value and Social Desirability, the respondents are response shows that they are highly motivated in their purchases and consumption based on functionality, prestige/image/reputation, and social desirability/acceptance.

Conclusion

1. The Filipino millennials attitude in the purchase and consumption luxury brand are more motivated due to ideal self congruity than on actual self congruity. The marketers should consider that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brand based on their ideal self congruity, hence they:
   - Would like to see themselves on the luxury brand
   - Would like people they look up to consume the luxury brand
   - Would like to be identified with those people who consume the luxury
2. The Filipino millennials attitude in the purchase and consumption luxury brand are more motivated due to ideal self congruity than on actual self congruity. The marketers should consider that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brand based on their ideal self congruity, hence they:
   - Would like to see themselves on the luxury brand
   - Would like people they look up to consume the luxury brand
   - Would like to be identified with those people who consume the luxury
3. The Filipino millennials attitude in the purchase and consumption luxury brand are more motivated due to ideal self congruity than on actual self congruity. The marketers should consider that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brand based on their ideal self congruity, hence they:
   - Would like to see themselves on the luxury brand
   - Would like people they look up to consume the luxury brand
   - Would like to be identified with those people who consume the luxury
   -

Recommendation

The marketers should consider that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brand based on their ideal self congruity, hence:

1. The luxury brand should be relatable, consistent, conform, coincide or in agreement with their ideal self.
2. The marketers should consider endorsers, models, advertising theme/slogans that in agreement with ideal self of the Filipino millennials which focuses on functionality, image/reputation, and social desirability in the promotional strategy, packaging, and distribution channel which are construed as high end and posh. The Filipino millennials attitude in the purchase and consumption luxury brand are more motivated due to ideal self congruity than on actual self congruity.
3. The marketers should consider that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brand based on their ideal self congruity, hence they:

- Would like to see themselves on the luxury brand
- Would like people they look up to consume the luxury brand
- Would like to be identified with those people who consume the luxury

Finally, one more limitation regarding this study is the lack of open-ended questions, which would have allowed respondents to express and explain their opinions in more detail. This would provide a more thorough understanding of underlying reasons of luxury consumption, though, many answers could be irrelevant regarding the chosen specific luxury value perceptions, as there are also several other ones that could be studied. Hence, it was determined not to include open-ended questions to avoid making the survey too extensive.

The research method used could also be different by doing a qualitative study to get broader insights into the phenomenon and so that the respondents can express their opinions more openly. This could be combined with a survey questionnaire that would be composed after the results of the qualitative study will be looked into, to focus on the most relevant aspects regarding the phenomenon and to find new ideas to be studied possibly.

Luxury brand consumption is a large and growing phenomenon and needs to be researched in more detail. This gives several opportunities for the development of research in the field.

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